

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF NEW YORK

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MEKHI ABBOTT,

Petitioner,

PETITION

-against-

CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY POLICE
DEPARTMENT, POLICE OFFICER WILFREDO BURGOS,
SHIELD # 13254 OF PATROL BOROUGH MANHATTAN
NORTH SPECIALIZED UNIT, POLICE OFFICER MICHAEL
DELIA, SHIELD #18222 OF PATROL BOROUGH
MANHATTAN NORTH SPECIALIZED UNIT, POLICE
OFFICER AHMED ALY, SHIELD #24874 OF PATROL
BOROUGH MANHATTAN NORTH SPECIALIZED UNIT
AND NEW YORK CITY POLICE OFFICERS JOHN DOE,

Respondent.

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JASON A. STEINBERGER, ESQ., an attorney duly licensed to practice law before the
Courts of the State of New York hereby affirms the following to be true under penalty of perjury
that:

1. I am the attorney for Plaintiff MEKHI ABBOTT and as such I am fully familiar
with the facts and circumstances surrounding the above captioned action. The basis for my
knowledge is derived from those files maintained by this office in connection with same.

2. I am respectfully submitting the instant Affirmation in Support of the instant
Petition pursuant to General Municipal Law § 50-e(5) therein granting leave to Petitioner to serve
a Late Notice of Claim on the Respondent, CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY POLICE
DEPARTMENT, POLICE OFFICER WILFREDO BURGOS, SHIELD # 13254 OF PATROL
BOROUGH MANHATTAN NORTH SPECIALIZED UNIT, POLICE OFFICER MICHAEL
DELIA, SHIELD #18222 OF PATROL BOROUGH MANHATTAN NORTH SPECIALIZED

UNIT, POLICE OFFICER AHMED ALY, SHIELD #24874 OF PATROL BOROUGH MANHATTAN NORTH SPECIALIZED UNIT AND NEW YORK CITY POLICE OFFICERS JOHN DOE, which will include causes of action for Malicious Prosecution. Please know a timely Notice of Claim was served for the causes of action for False Arrest and False Imprisonment.

3. I make this Petition upon information and belief. The sources of my information are a review of the Criminal Court Complaint, Certificate of Disposition and speaking with petitioner.

4. On or about March 25, 2022 Police Officers Wilfredo Burgos, Michael Delia, Ahmed Aly and Police Officers John Doe arrested Petitioner for Criminal Possession of a Weapon in the Second Degree and related offenses despite the fact that Petitioner never committed a crime or offense and that each of the above mentioned officers knew that Petitioner had not committed a crime or offense. (Exhibit B)

5. On or about August 10, 2022, the Office of the New York County District Attorney dismissed each of the charges against Petitioner. (Exhibit C)

6. On or about July 21, 2022 Petitioner filed a Notice of Claim with the City New York and New York City Police Department alleging causes of action for False Arrest, False Imprisonment, Violation of Civil Rights under §1983, 42 USC and malicious prosecution after Petitioner believed his case had been dismissed upon his release from New York City Department of Corrections custody on July 12, 2022. (Exhibit D)

7. It is well settled that the Court may, in its discretion, extend the time to serve a notice of claim. See, Matter of Lodati v. City of New York 303 A.D.2d 406 (2nd Dept. 2003); Matter of Allen, 268 A.D.2d 520 (2nd Dept. 2000). In determining whether to grant an application for leave to file a late notice claim, “the key factors which the Supreme Court must consider are whether the movant demonstrated a reasonable excuse for the failure to timely file a notice of claim, whether the municipality acquired actual notice of the essential facts of the claim within 90 days after the claim arose or within a reasonable time thereafter, and whether the delay would substantially prejudice the municipality in its defense.” Burgess v. County of Suffolk, 56 A.D.3d 769 (2nd Dept 2008). Neither the presence nor the absence of any one factor is determinative. See, Matter of Dell’Italia v. Long Island Corp., 31 A.D.3d 758 (2nd Dept. 2006). In accord with the General Municipal Law, the Court must give particular consideration to whether municipality acquired actual notice of the essential facts of the claim within 90 days after the claims arose ***or within a reasonable time thereafter.*** See, Munro v. Ossining Union Free School District, 55 A.D.3d 697 (2nd Dept., 2008).

8. In review of the proposed Notice of Claim, please find attached a copy of the Notice of Claim served on November 30, 2022.

9. It is well accepted law that for claims of false arrest, false imprisonment, malicious prosecution, negligent hiring, negligent training and negligent supervision where the police department conducts an extensive investigation in which the District Attorney’s office joins and participates, knowledge of the essential facts constituting the claims can be imputed to the City of New York within the statutory period. Hence the City cannot claim prejudice by any

delay. Grullon v. City of New York, 222 A.D.2d 257, 635 N.Y.S.2d 24 (1st Dept., 1995); Nunez v. City of New York, 307 A.D.2d 218, 762 N.Y.S.2d 384 (1st Dept., 2003); Phillipe v. City of New York, 8 Misc.3d 1016A, 803 N.Y.S.2d 20 (Sup. Ct., NY Co., Ling-Cohan, J., 2005).

10. Accordingly, Respondent had actual knowledge of the incident giving rise to the instant proceeding.

11. In the present case, the City of New York, its agents, servants and employees, arrested, imprisoned and prosecuted Petitioner. Hence the Notice of Claim is certainly timely as to those claims under the General Municipal Law

12. As the First Department in Grullon v. City of New York, supra, stated in cases where the delay “...was not a lengthy one” and where the City of New York by the police department and District Attorney’s office were actively involved in the investigation of the criminal charges on which the civil claims are based, there is simply no prejudice and no valid reason to deny Claimant the right to timely file a Notice of Claim on all the stated causes of action.

13. That based upon the foregoing, it is respectfully requested that the Petitioners be granted leave to file the proposed late notice of claim annexed hereto.

14. That no prior request for relief has been made.

Dated: Bronx, New York
November 30, 2022

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Attorney for the Petitioners

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